

RP05

State Secretariat, Chief Secretary and Directorates

Expect 1-2 questions a paper from this chapter, and they are gettable. The first Chief Secretary came in 2013, 2021 and 2023 - it sits inside the wider firsts cluster that RPSC asks every other year. Rajasthan e-governance portals including Raj Kaj came in 2018, 2021 and 2024. Format is one-liner, headquarters matching, penalty classification and statement-based.

This is the chapter on the machine that actually runs Rajasthan. Two things carry it in the exam. One, the Secretariat versus Directorate distinction - a classic RPSC discriminator that comes back as a statement or assertion-reason question. Two, the firsts and the rule-books - K. Radhakrishnan as first Chief Secretary, the CCA Rules of 1958, the Conduct Rules of 1971, and the exact mechanics of RAS promotion to the IAS.

Rajasthan Secretariat, Chief Secretary and the state services

Secretariat - staff

agency

- Shasan Sachivalaya, Jaipur
- Policy, budget, legislation
- Coordination between departments
- Supervises the directorates

Directorate - line agency

- Field execution
- Headed by a Director / HoD
- Technical and specialist advice
- Controls district-level staff

Chief Secretary

- First - K. Radhakrishnan, 1949
- Senior-most IAS of the state cadre
- Appointed by the Chief Minister
- Secretary to the Council of Ministers
- Head of DoP and General Administration

Articles

- 166 conduct of state business
- 167 CM's duty to the Governor
- 309 recruitment and conditions
- 310 doctrine of pleasure
- 311 safeguards

RAS

- RPSC combined exam
- 1999 Direct Recruitment Rules
- Cadre controller - Department of Personnel
- SDM to ADM to Deputy Secretary

RAS to IAS

- IAS Promotion Regulations 1955
- Selection Committee chaired by UPSC
- Ceiling 33 1/3 per cent of senior duty posts
- Minimum eight years in RAS

Rules and training

- CCA Rules 1958 - discipline
- Conduct Rules 1971 - behaviour
- HCM RIPA, Jaipur, 1957 (OTS)
- Raj Kaj, IFMS, SSO, Jan Soochna

What the Secretariat is, and what it is not

The State Secretariat - Shasan Sachivalaya - at Jaipur is the apex office of the Government of Rajasthan. Physically it is one complex; administratively it is the collection of all the departments of the state government at their topmost level. The Chief Minister sits there, the ministers sit there, the Chief Secretary sits there, and each department has a Secretary there.

Now the idea that the whole chapter turns on. The Secretariat is a staff agency. A staff agency thinks, advises and coordinates; it does not go into the field. It drafts the policy, prepares the budget, frames the rules and answers the legislature. The actual execution - running the schools, the hospitals, the mines department's field offices - is done by somebody else. Hold that thought; the somebody else is the Directorate.

- Assists ministers in formulating policy - the core function.
 - Legislative and budget work of the department.
 - Framing service rules and financial rules.
 - Coordination between departments so that decisions do not collide.
 - Supervising and evaluating the work of the directorates under it.
 - Preparing cases for the Cabinet and following up on Cabinet decisions.
-
- It is located at Jaipur, the state capital - unlike many directorates and boards, which are scattered.
 - Each department is headed politically by a minister and administratively by a Secretary.
 - A Secretariat department may have more than one directorate under it.
 - It does NOT itself implement schemes in the districts. This negative is asked directly.

Secretariat versus Directorate - the discriminator RPSC loves

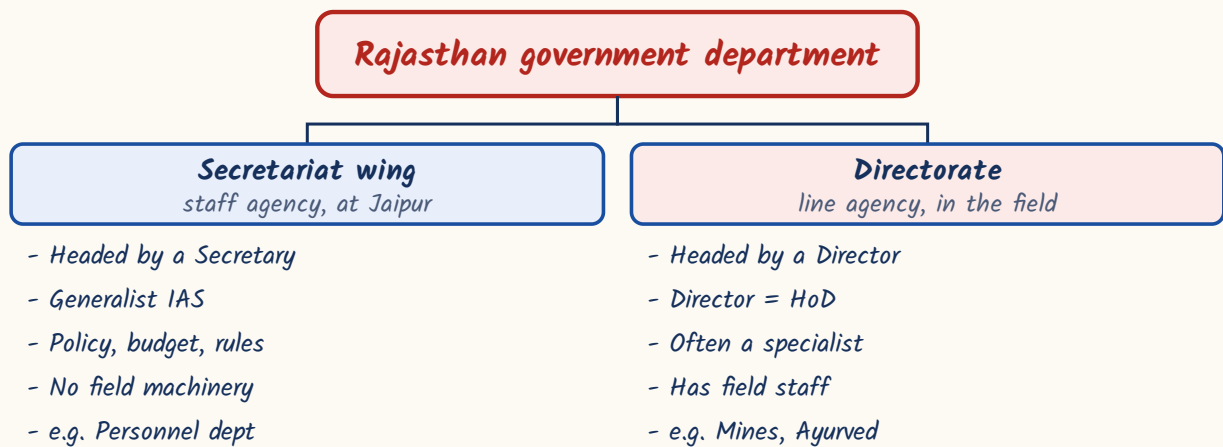
If you remember one comparison from Rajasthan Administration, make it this one. The Secretariat is the staff or policy-making agency; the Directorate is the line or executing agency. Everything else - who heads it, whether the officer is a generalist or a technical specialist, whether the office is at Jaipur or elsewhere - follows from that one difference. RPSC has set it as a plain one-liner, as a two-statement question and as an assertion-reason pair.

Secretariat versus Directorate

Secretariat	Directorate
Staff agency - thinks, advises, coordinates	Line agency - executes in the field
Policy formulation, budget, legislation, rules	Implementation of programmes and schemes
Headed by a Secretary, normally a generalist IAS officer	Headed by a Director, also called Head of Department, often a technical specialist
Works directly under the minister	Works under the administrative control of the Secretariat department
Concentrated at Jaipur	Located wherever convenient - Bikaner, Udaipur, Ajmer, Jaipur
Advises on the whole department's policy	Gives technical advice and supervises district-level staff
No direct field machinery of its own	Has a field establishment down to the district and block

Why keep them separate at all? Because a minister needs advice from someone who is not answerable for the day-to-day work being reviewed. The Secretariat gives the detached second opinion; the Directorate gives the expert first-hand one. The cost of this design is the classic complaint of Indian administration - delay and duplication, and a running turf fight between the Secretary and the Director. That criticism is itself a standard descriptive-answer point. Two usages to keep: the Director is officially the Head of Department, HoD, and the Directorate has no policy-making power of its own - it works inside the policy the Secretariat lays down.

Two arms of one department



TRAP

Do not say the Directorate is subordinate to the Secretariat in the sense of a junior office. It is functionally under the administrative control of the Secretariat department, but a Director can be senior in service to a Deputy Secretary. Also do not answer that the Secretariat implements schemes - that is the wrong option planted in almost every NOT-correct question on this topic.

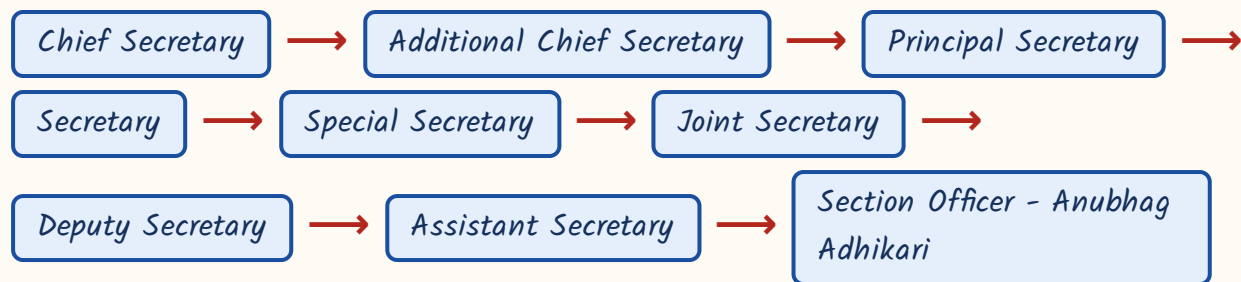
The hierarchy inside the Secretariat, and its constitutional basis

The Secretariat is a ladder, and the ladder is asked as an ordering question.

Learn it downward from the Chief Secretary. Note that Additional Chief

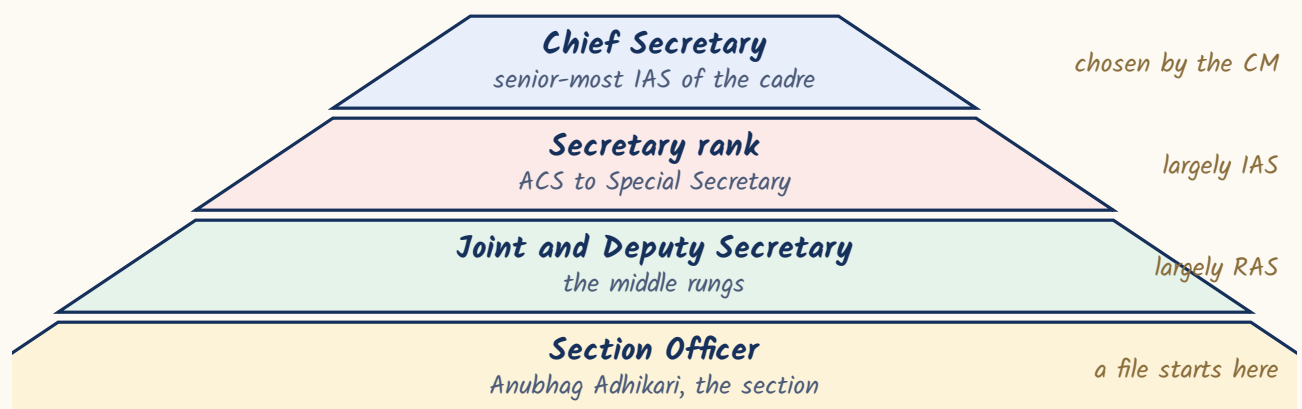
Secretary, Principal Secretary, Secretary and Special Secretary are all secretary-rank posts - the difference is seniority and pay level, not a different kind of job.

The Secretariat ladder, top to bottom



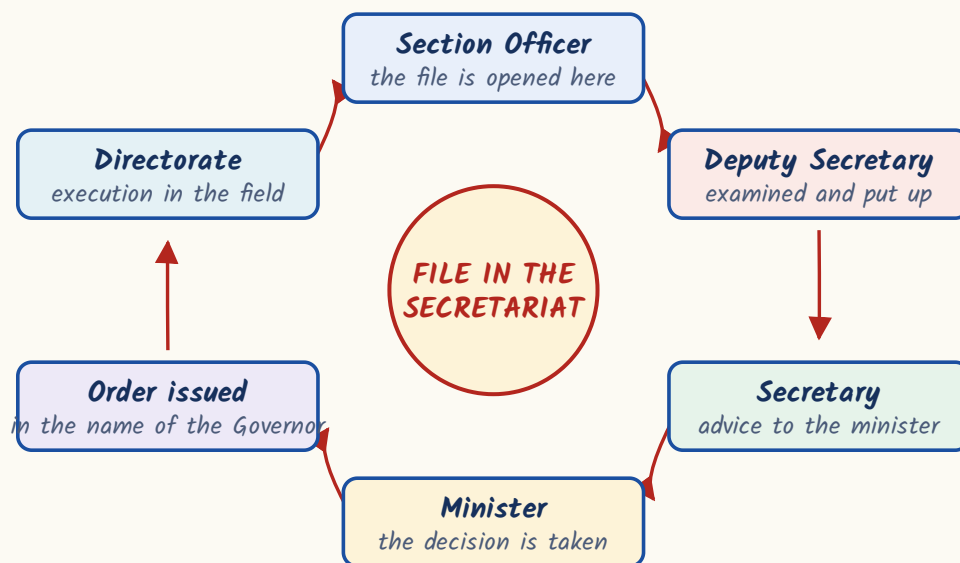
- The Section Officer, Anubhag Adhikari, runs the section - the smallest unit of the Secretariat and where a file starts its journey.
- Deputy Secretary and Joint Secretary levels are largely filled by RAS officers.
- Secretary rank and above is largely IAS.
- A file typically moves Section Officer to Deputy Secretary to Secretary to Minister, and back down with the decision.

Who staffs which rung of the Secretariat



Where does the Secretariat get its legal shape from? From Article 166. All executive action of the Government of Rajasthan is expressed to be taken in the name of the Governor - that is 166(1). Orders are authenticated in the manner specified in rules made by the Governor - 166(2), and once authenticated, their validity cannot be questioned on the ground that they are not orders of the Governor. And under 166(3) the Governor makes Rules of Business for the more convenient transaction of the business of the government and for allocating that business among ministers. Those Rajasthan Government Rules of Business are what actually create departments and hand them to ministers.

The journey of a file



The two Articles that govern state business

Article	Provision
166(1)	All executive action expressed in the name of the Governor
166(2)	Authentication of orders and instruments
166(3)	Governor makes Rules of Business and allocates business among ministers
167	Duty of the Chief Minister to communicate Council of Ministers decisions to the Governor and furnish information he calls for

The Chief Secretary - the pivot of the whole system

The Chief Secretary is the administrative head of the entire state administration. He is not mentioned in the Constitution and there is no fixed tenure attached to the post. He is normally the senior-most IAS officer serving in the Rajasthan cadre, and he is appointed by the Chief Minister. That last point is the one RPSC tests, because students assume the Governor or the UPSC appoints him. They do not.

- Chief adviser to the Chief Minister.
- Secretary to the Council of Ministers - he keeps its records and follows up its decisions.
- Head of the Secretariat and of the civil services of the state.
- Head of the Department of Personnel and of General Administration.
- Chairman of the state Civil Services Board and of a long list of state-level committees.
- Principal channel of communication between the state government and the Government of India, and residuary legatee for work not assigned to any other secretary.

ASKED IN RAS

Who was the first Chief Secretary of Rajasthan? K. Radhakrishnan, 13 April 1949 to 2 May 1950. Asked in RAS Pre 2021 and again in 2023, and as part of a statement set in 2013. This is one of the safest marks in the whole Rajasthan Polity syllabus.

ASKED IN RAS

RPSC asks Rajasthan's firsts as a cluster, so revise them together - first Rajpramukh Maharaja Sawai Man Singh II, first Governor Gurumukh Nihal Singh, first Chief Secretary K. Radhakrishnan, first Chief Justice of the High Court Kamal Kant Verma. The 2013, 2021 and 2023 papers all dipped into this list.

Chief Secretaries of Rajasthan - the ones worth knowing

Chief Secretary	Period
K. Radhakrishnan - the first	13 April 1949 to 2 May 1950
Niranjan Kumar Arya	November 2020 to January 2022
Usha Sharma	February 2022 to December 2023
Sudhansh Pant	January 2024 to 16 November 2025
V. Srinivas	From 17 November 2025

CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026 - V. Srinivas took charge as Chief Secretary of Rajasthan on 17 November 2025, succeeding Sudhansh Pant, and press reports in August 2026 said his tenure was extended by six months. Learn the chronology Arya, Sharma, Pant, Srinivas as a sequence, because RPSC turns recent office-holders into ordering questions rather than one-liners.

TRAP

He is NOT appointed by the Governor on the UPSC's recommendation, and he does NOT hold a fixed statutory tenure. He is chosen by the Chief Minister from the senior-most IAS officers of the state cadre. Also, he is Secretary TO the Council of Ministers - not a member of it.

The departments that run the machine, and e-governance

A handful of Secretariat departments cut across every other department, and those are the ones that get asked. The Department of Personnel is the most important of them. In Rajasthan it is normally held by the Chief Minister himself, and it is the cadre controlling authority for both the IAS and the Rajasthan Administrative Service - service rules, postings, transfers, seniority lists. If a question asks who controls the RAS cadre, the answer is the Department of Personnel, Government of Rajasthan.

Cross-cutting departments and what they do

Department	Principal function
Department of Personnel	Cadre control for IAS and RAS, service rules, postings and transfers; held by the Chief Minister
Administrative Reforms Department	Administrative reform, e-governance, citizen's charters, public service delivery law
General Administration Department	Inter-departmental coordination and Secretariat establishment
Finance Department	Budget preparation and financial control
Planning Department	Plan formulation, evaluation and state statistics

The Administrative Reforms Department is the nodal agency for the two service-delivery laws you should be able to name - the Rajasthan Guaranteed Delivery of Public Services Act, 2011, which fixes time limits for notified services, and the Rajasthan Right to Hearing Act, 2012, which gives a citizen the right to be heard on a grievance. It is also the department behind citizen's charters in the state.

ASKED IN RAS

Citizen's charter has been asked in the negative form - which of the following is NOT a component of a citizen's charter - in RAS Pre 2021 and again in 2024. For this chapter just fix the ownership: the Administrative Reforms Department is the nodal department for charters in Rajasthan. The components themselves belong to the governance chapter.

- Raj Kaj - the integrated e-office and employee services application of the Department of Personnel; e-file movement, service records, leave, transfers.
- IFMS - Integrated Financial Management System, for budget, payments and treasury work.
- SSO Rajasthan - the single sign-on gateway for state online services.
- Rajasthan Sampark - the grievance registration and redressal portal.
- e-Mitra - the service delivery kiosk network.
- Jan Soochna portal, launched 2019 - proactive disclosure of scheme and beneficiary data under the RTI idea.

ASKED IN RAS

Rajasthan's e-governance portals are a recurring current-affairs style question - Jan Aadhaar, RAJ NIVESH and Raj Kaj were tested in 2018, 2021 and 2024. Know each one by its one-line purpose. Raj Kaj is for government employees and files, not for citizens - that distinction is the trick in the option set.

CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026 - revise the state's digital stack as one cluster owned by the Secretariat, because RPSC keeps pulling one name out of it and asking what it does. Raj Kaj is the Department of Personnel's e-office for employees and files; IFMS is money; SSO Rajasthan is the single sign-on gate; Rajasthan Sampark is grievances; e-Mitra is the kiosk counter; the Jan Soochna portal of 2019 is proactive disclosure. The two service-delivery laws behind them, the Guaranteed Delivery of Public Services Act 2011 and the Right to Hearing Act 2012, sit with the Administrative Reforms Department and do not change.

The Directorates and where they sit

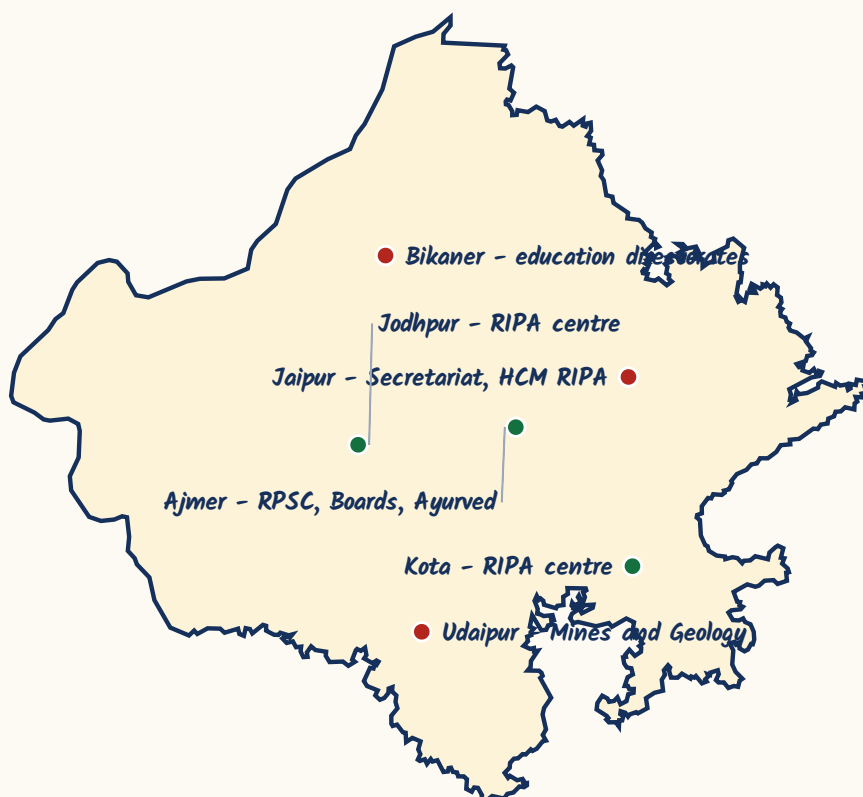
Directorates are the executing arm, and RPSC asks them in only one way - headquarters matching. Rajasthan deliberately spread its directorates and boards across cities rather than piling everything into Jaipur, which is exactly what makes the matching question possible. Learn the list by city, not by department.

Offices and their headquarters - learn this cold

Office	Headquarters
Directorate of Elementary Education	Bikaner
Directorate of Secondary Education	Bikaner
Directorate of Mines and Geology	Udaipur
Directorate of Ayurved	Ajmer
Rajasthan Public Service Commission (1949)	Ajmer
Board of Secondary Education, Rajasthan	Ajmer
Board of Revenue for Rajasthan	Ajmer

- Ajmer is the standing answer - RPSC, Board of Secondary Education, Board of Revenue, Rajasthan Tax Board and the Ayurved directorate are all there.
- Bikaner owns school education - both the elementary and the secondary education directorates.
- Udaipur owns mines and geology, which fits the southern mineral belt.
- The Board of Revenue at Ajmer sits outside the Secretariat-Directorate chain altogether; it is a court, not an executive office.

Directorates, boards and training centres



HCM RIPA, Jaipur (1957) has regional centres at Udaipur, Bikaner, Jodhpur and Kota

TRAP

Directorate of Mines and Geology is at Udaipur, not Jodhpur and not Jaipur. Jodhpur has the High Court, Ajmer has the boards and the commission, Bikaner has education, Udaipur has mines. RPSC's NOT-correctly-matched question in this chapter is almost always built on one of these four.

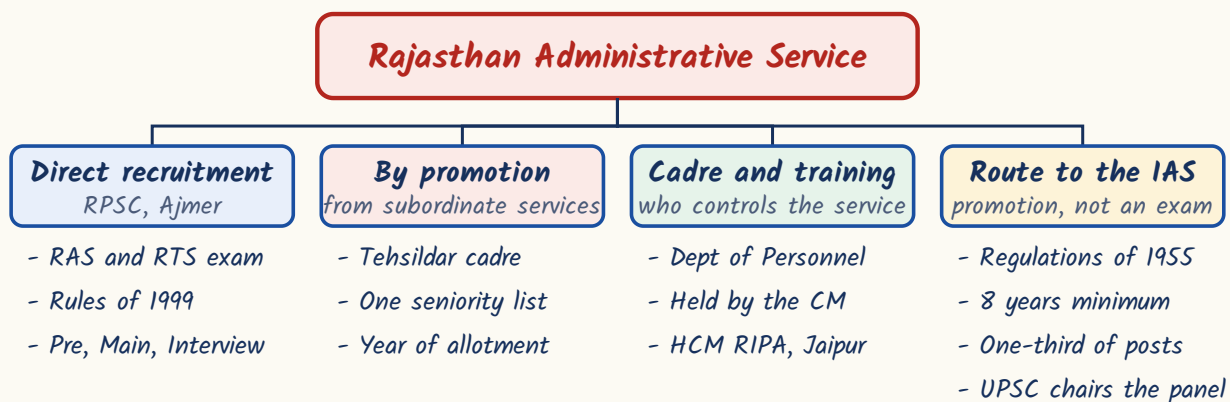
The Rajasthan Administrative Service - cadre and recruitment

The RAS is the premier state civil service of Rajasthan. Think of it as the state's own IAS. Its officers staff the sub-divisions, the additional collector posts and the middle rungs of the Secretariat, and a share of them eventually enter the IAS by promotion. Its cadre controlling authority is the Department of Personnel.

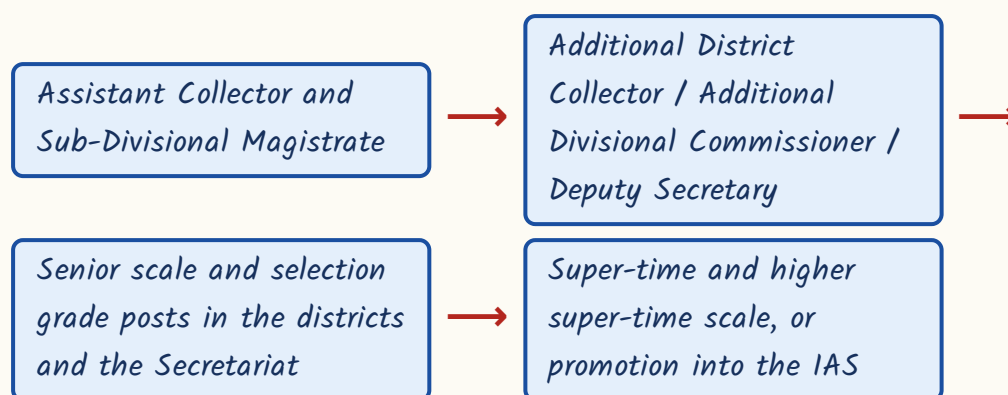
Recruitment happens two ways. Direct recruits come through the RAS and RTS Combined Competitive Examination conducted by the Rajasthan Public Service Commission at Ajmer, held under the Rajasthan State and Subordinate Services (Direct Recruitment by Combined Competitive Examinations) Rules, 1999. A part of the cadre is filled by promotion from subordinate services such as the Tehsildar cadre. Both streams end up in the same service, and seniority is then worked out by year of allotment and merit position.

- Conducting body - RPSC, not the UPSC. This is a standard wrong option.
- Governing rules for the examination - the 1999 Direct Recruitment Rules.
- Three stages - Preliminary, Main and Interview or personality test.
- One examination recruits to both state services (RAS) and subordinate services (RTS).
- Seniority follows year of allotment and position in the merit list.
- Foundation training and in-service training are given at HCM RIPA.

The RAS - entry, control and exit



A typical RAS career path



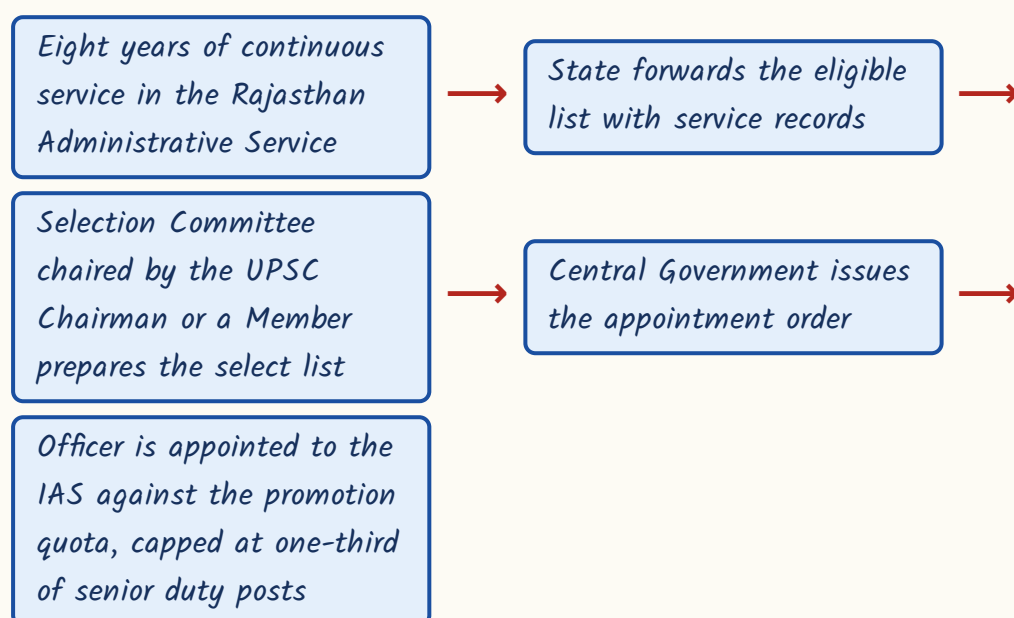
- The constitutional base for all of this is Article 309 - the legislature, or until it acts the Governor, regulates recruitment and conditions of service.
- Article 308 to 314 form the Services chapter of the Constitution.
- The state cannot create an All India Service; only Parliament can, under Article 312.

RAS to IAS, and where officers are trained

This is the most technical part of the chapter and therefore the most examinable. An RAS officer does not write another examination to become an IAS officer. He is promoted, and the promotion is controlled by rules made at the Centre, not in Jaipur. Four numbers carry the whole topic - 1955, one-third, eight years, and a UPSC chairman.

- Governing rules - the IAS (Appointment by Promotion) Regulations, 1955.
- Not more than 33 1/3 per cent - one-third - of the senior duty posts of a state's IAS cadre may be filled by promotion and by selection from other sources.
- Minimum eight years of continuous service in the State Civil Service to be eligible for inclusion in the select list.
- The Selection Committee is chaired by the Chairman or a Member of the Union Public Service Commission.
- The Committee prepares a select list; the appointment order is issued by the Central Government.
- So the state proposes, the UPSC-chaired committee selects, and the Centre appoints.

How an RAS officer reaches the IAS



YAAD RAKHO

Remember 1955 - 8 - 33. Regulations of 1955, eight years minimum service, one-third ceiling. And the chair is always UPSC, never RPSC - that swap is the single most likely wrong option in this area.

Training is the other half of this section. HCM Rajasthan State Institute of Public Administration at Jaipur, established in 1957, is the apex civil services training institute of the state. It is popularly called OTS - the Officers Training School - and it is named after the parliamentarian Harish Chandra Mathur. It runs foundation and in-service courses for RAS, RPS, RAcS and other state services, and also trains IAS officers of the Rajasthan cadre. It has regional training centres at Udaipur, Bikaner, Jodhpur and Kota.

Service rules - discipline under CCA 1958 and conduct under 1971

Two rule-books govern a Rajasthan government servant's working life, and the exam wants you to keep them apart. The Rajasthan Civil Services (Classification, Control and Appeal) Rules, 1958 deal with what happens when something goes wrong - classification of services, who the disciplinary authority is, how the inquiry runs, what penalties may be imposed, and where the appeal lies. The Rajasthan Civil Services (Conduct) Rules, 1971 deal with everyday behaviour - what an officer may and may not do while nothing has gone wrong at all. Discipline versus conduct. 1958 versus 1971.

Penalties under the CCA Rules, 1958

Minor penalties	Major penalties
Censure	Reduction in rank or in pay
Withholding of promotion	Compulsory retirement
Recovery of pecuniary loss caused to government	Removal from service

Minor penalties	Major penalties
Withholding of increments	Dismissal from service

- A major penalty requires a full formal inquiry - charge sheet, inquiry officer, hearing; a minor penalty follows a lighter procedure.
- Removal and dismissal both end the service; dismissal additionally disqualifies from future government employment.
- An appeal lies to the authority prescribed above the disciplinary authority.
- Article 310 - the doctrine of pleasure; a state civil servant holds office during the pleasure of the Governor.
- Article 311(1) - no dismissal or removal by an authority subordinate to the appointing authority.
- Article 311(2) - no dismissal, removal or reduction in rank except after an inquiry in which the servant is informed of the charges and given a reasonable opportunity of being heard.
- Article 311(2) has three exceptions - conviction on a criminal charge, where an inquiry is not reasonably practicable, and where the President or Governor certifies that an inquiry is against the security of the state.

Now the Conduct Rules of 1971. The opening obligation is the widest one - every government servant shall maintain absolute integrity and devotion to duty and shall do nothing unbecoming of a government servant. Around that sit the specific bars. No acceptance of gifts beyond the prescribed limits. No trade or business, and no employment elsewhere, without sanction. No unauthorised public criticism of the policy of the government. Annual property returns must be filed. No speculation in stocks or shares. These are the exact heads RPSC pulls its statements from.

TRAP

Censure is a MINOR penalty, not a major one. That single swap is the most common question built on the CCA Rules. Second confusion to kill - the 1958 Rules are Classification, Control and Appeal, the 1971 Rules are Conduct. If the question is about gifts, property returns or criticising government policy, the answer is 1971.

REVISION RECAP

1. Secretariat at Jaipur is the staff and policy agency; Directorate is the line and executing agency.
2. Secretary heads a Secretariat department; Director, also called Head of Department, heads a directorate.
3. Ladder - Chief Secretary, ACS, Principal Secretary, Secretary, Special, Joint, Deputy, Assistant Secretary, Section Officer.
4. Article 166 - executive action in the Governor's name, authentication, and the Rules of Business made by the Governor.
5. Article 167 - the Chief Minister's duty to communicate Council of Ministers decisions to the Governor.
6. Chief Secretary - administrative head of the state, senior-most IAS of the cadre, appointed by the Chief Minister, no fixed tenure.
7. He is Secretary to the Council of Ministers and head of the Department of Personnel and General Administration.
8. First Chief Secretary - K. Radhakrishnan, April 1949 to May 1950.
9. Recent sequence - Arya, Usha Sharma, Sudhansh Pant, V. Srinivas from 17 November 2025.
10. Department of Personnel is held by the Chief Minister and is the cadre controlling authority for IAS and RAS; Raj Kaj is its e-office.
11. Administrative Reforms Department - charters, the 2011 Guaranteed Delivery of Public Services Act and the 2012 Right to Hearing Act.
12. Education directorates at Bikaner, Mines and Geology at Udaipur, Ayurved at Ajmer.
13. Ajmer cluster - RPSC (1949), Board of Secondary Education, Board of Revenue, Rajasthan Tax Board.
14. RAS recruited by RPSC under the 1999 Direct Recruitment Rules; part of the cadre comes by promotion from subordinate services.

15. RAS path - SDM, then Additional Collector or Deputy Secretary; seniority by year of allotment and merit.
16. RAS to IAS - Promotion Regulations 1955, eight years minimum, one-third ceiling on senior duty posts.
17. The Selection Committee is chaired by the UPSC Chairman or a Member; the Central Government issues the order.
18. HCM RIPA, Jaipur, 1957, popularly OTS, named after Harish Chandra Mathur; centres at Udaipur, Bikaner, Jodhpur, Kota.
19. CCA Rules 1958 for discipline and penalties; Conduct Rules 1971 for behaviour; censure is a minor penalty.
20. Article 309 recruitment and conditions, 310 doctrine of pleasure, 311 the two safeguards against dismissal.